

Karolina Nugumanova

Gender Justice — Migration — Political Behavior — Russia — Mix methods

Scuola Normale Superiore

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Research Profile

I am a PhD candidate in political science and sociology specializing in the gendered dimensions of forced political displacement under conditions of war and authoritarianism. My research examines how emotions, political opportunity structures, and transnational repression shape the experiences, vulnerabilities, and civic engagement of politically displaced populations, with a particular focus on women migrants from post-2022 Russia. Methodologically, I combine large-scale panel surveys, experiments, and in-depth qualitative interviews to produce research with both academic and policy relevance for migration governance, protection frameworks, and gender justice initiatives.

Academic Appointments

Visiting Fellow , <i>Harvard University</i> (Davis Center for Russian and Eurasian Studies)	Upcoming: Jan–May 2027
Visiting Research Fellow , University of Tokyo, Institute of Social Science Invited by Prof. Masaaki Higashijima	Apr–Aug 2026
Visiting Research Fellow , Waseda University, Faculty of Human Sciences Invited by Prof. Naoto Higuchi	Apr–Aug 2026

Education

PhD in Political Science and Sociology , Scuola Normale Superiore Academic advisors: Martín Portos García; Lorenzo Zamponi. Dissertation: <i>Gendered Mobilization in Exile: Understanding the Activism of Post-2022 Russian Emigrants through Emotions, Structure, and Movement Dynamics</i> .	Expected 2027
MA in Sociology , European University at St. Petersburg — Exchange Student, <i>Venice International University</i> (Feb–May 2021)	2020–2022
BA in Sociology , Novosibirsk State University	2016–2020

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

🔗 Nugumanova, Karolina. Micromobilising Emotion: How Feminist Anti-War Resistance Builds Affective Infrastructure in Exile. <i>Communist and Post-Communist Studies</i> (SSCI, Scopus).	2026
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Manuscripts Under Review / Advanced Stage

Nugumanova, K., Kamalov, E., & Sergeeva, I. *Reverse Gender Gap in Transnational Activism: War-Driven Political Engagement among Russian Post-2022 Emigrants.*

Selected Works in Progress

Kamalov, E., Nugumanova, K., & Sergeeva, I. *Exposure to Transnational Repression and Political Engagement: Evidence from a Panel of Russian Exiles.*

Kamalov, E., Nugumanova, K., & Sergeeva, I. *Destination Preferences in Secondary Migration Among Politically Induced Migrants from Authoritarian States: Evidence from a Conjoint Experiment.*

Nugumanova, K. *The Gendered Opportunity Structure of Exile: How Host-Country Contexts Shape Migrant Political Participation.*

Academic Positions and Research Projects

Principal Investigator, *The Science of Dreams* (1500+ respondents). 2022–present

Principal Investigator, *Media Literacy and Critical Thinking* (WOT-Foundation). 2021–2022

Co-Investigator, *OutRush*, Panel Survey on Russian emigrants 2022–present

Co-Investigator, *Democracy in Exile* (DemEx Project, NSF-funded). 2024–present

Co-Investigator, *Feminist Anti-War Resistance in Exile* (55 interviews). 2023–2024

Researcher, *Building a Commons in the Russian Diaspora* (580 interviews). 2022–2023

Expert and Foresight Facilitator, *European Commission*. 2024–2025

Competitive Grants and Fellowships

€74,000 — PhD Fellowship, PNRR (Italy), fully funded doctoral grant 2023–2027

€8,570 — MA Scholarship, European University at St. Petersburg 2020–2022

€5,000 — Mobility Research Grant, Scuola Normale Superiore 2023–2025

€4,458 — Visiting Fellow Grant, Scuola Normale Superiore 2026

€400 — SPS Summer Academy travel grant, European University Institute 2022

Awards and Prizes

National Sociology Olympiad (Russia) — Higher School of Economics 2020–2022

Silver Award (2022) — €1,500

Bronze Award (2021) — €1,000

Winner (2020) — honorary award

Teaching and Guest Lectures

Guest lecture (co-led session), *Political Behavior* — Scuola Normale Superiore, Florence. Topic: 2025
Gender inequalities in political participation. [Syllabus]

Guest lecture, Summer School *GENDER-LIKBEZ 4.0* — European University at St. Petersburg. 2023
Topic: Gender differences in political and civic activism among Russian migrants.

Research Reports and Analytical Publications

- 🌀 *On the Move: Mobility, Integration, and Dynamics of Russian Emigration in 2022–2024*, with Kamalov and Sergeeva. 2025
- 🌀 *From Russia to Latin America: Integration, Challenges, and Aspirations of Russian Post-2022 Emigrants*, with Kamalov and Sergeeva. 2025
- 🌀 *Men’s Words, Women’s Work: Exploring the Reverse Gender Gap in Post-2022 Russian Emigration. Russian Analytical Digest*. 2024
- 🌀 *Mapping and Gathering Russian Artists and Cultural Workers in Exile*. 2024
- 🌀 *One and a Half Years Later: Progress and Barriers in the Integration of Russian Emigrants*. 2024
- 🌀 *‘Great, Great Sorrow and Eternal Silence’: An Experiment in Sociological Dream Interpretation after February 24, 2022. The February Journal*. 2023
- 🌀 *How do you sleep during the war? Posle Media*. 2023
- 🌀 *I had a dream about Putin. What war-time dreams tell us about reality. Republic (in Russian)*. 2023

Selected Academic Conferences and Talks

- ECPR (European Consortium for Political Research)**, presenter 2025, 2026
- ASEEES Annual Convention**, presenter and discussant 2024, 2025
- ISA / ESA / AIS Gens Conference (Gender Studies)**, presenter 2025
- Aleksanteri Conference**, University of Helsinki, presenter 2023, 2024
- Russia Expert Seminar**, European University Institute, invited speaker 2025
- Migration and Diversity Workshop**, ZoiS, Berlin, invited speaker 2025
- Migration Working Group**, European University Institute, presenter 2024
- Gender, Peace and Security Workshop**, British Institute of East Africa, presenter 2025
- LCSR Workshop on Comparative Values**, Higher School of Economics, presenter 2024
- Cross-Border Voices Workshop**, ZoiS, Ilia State University, invited speaker 2024
- Cross-Border Repression and Solidarity**, University of Helsinki, Riga, invited speaker 2024
- New Russian Exodus Seminar**, Yerevan State University, invited speaker 2024

Professional Training and Methods Training

- Data Scientist in R**, DataCamp (88-hour course) 2022
- GESIS Spring Seminar**, Experimental Designs in Social and Behavioral Studies 2025
- Spring School on Democratic Backsliding and Political Conflicts**, EUI & SNS 2022
- CITI Program**, Ethics in Human Research (Indiana University requirement) 2022
- EUI SPS Summer Academy**, “(In)equality, Democracy and Solidarity in Europe” 2022

Academic Service

Reviewer for *European Journal of Politics and Gender*; *Problems of Post-Communism* (SSCI-indexed).
Conference discussant: ASEEES (2025); European Graduate Network (2024).

Skills

Languages: Russian (native), English (advanced), Italian (intermediate).

Methods: multilevel modeling; panel surveys and conjoint experiments; qualitative interviews.

Software: R; $\text{\LaTeX}$; Qualtrics; Git; MaxQDA; MS Office Suite.

Research practice: ethical and trauma-informed interviewing and research with human subjects (CITI certification); participatory and feminist research methods; research with vulnerable and displaced populations; reproducible research; open science and research data management (certified by Scuola Normale Superiore).

Updated: February 2026